

Digit at your service

From antivirus to overclocking, all your questions answered!

COM SURROGATE problem

I have a Dell Studio 15 laptop with a 2 GHz Intel Core 2 Duo processor, 250 GB hard disk, 2 GB of memory with McAfee antivirus preloaded. I haven't updated my antivirus and now, I have errors "COM SURROGATE has stopped working" and "Rundll32 error; Windows has stopped working" that occur when I open any folder on my laptop. I need to know what the reason is for it and also the solution.

Sathiya Moorthy

The problem you're facing is because of some kind of codec issues. If you use a codec pack, uninstall it and check if the problem is fixed. Try installing individual codec from here on. Also, go to the Advanced System Settings from the Control Panel > System menu. Try changing the DEP settings for the binary dllhost.exe.

Multiple queries

My system configuration is as follows:

- Intel Pentium Dual Core E2200
- Intel DG31PR motherboard
- Transcend 1 GB DDR2 RAM
- 250 GB 7200 rpm SATA HDD
- Sony DVD RW AW-G170A
- Benq 52X CD ROM DRIVE
- Windows XP Service Pack 2

If this isn't any good, how can I improve? My DVD writer doesn't read some DVDs. Those DVDs are playable on standalone DVD Players. What could be the problem?

I need to buy a graphics card.

My friends play great games on their PCs using dedicated graphics card. I would love to play games such as Crysis, Burnout Paradise, The Sims, Far Cry 2, Fear 2 and Call Of Duty. Please suggest me a cheap graphics card.

Are Blu-Ray writers available in the market? Tell give me more details. I also want to buy a cheap 4 GB pen drive. Suggest one.

Amal Raj

In our opinion, your PC is getting slightly outdated. A processor upgrade will go a long way for now and you should also upgrade to 3 or 4 GB of RAM.

There might be a problem with your DVD writer. You should try using it on another PC. If it isn't working, send it for replacement if it's under warranty.

For the games you want to play, look for a GeForce 9800GTX+ or a Radeon HD4850 if your budget is under Rs. 8,000 or so. If you can spend around Rs. 15,000, look for the Radeon HD4890 or a GeForce GTX275. Do this after you've upgraded your processor.

Blu-ray writers are difficult to

find in India. If available, they will be extremely expensive. The price in the US market is somewhere over Rs.

20,000. A 4 GB Kingston Data Traveller USB drive should be under Rs.

500. Also, look around for OCZ drives.

Internet connection crashes

Whenever I connect to the internet from the BSNL USB LAN card, an error window pops up. After clicking on Don't Send, the internet connections stops.

My computer configuration is given below:

Intel Pentium 4 2.66 GHz, 768 MB RAM, 80 GB HDD.

Sandip Patel

The crash could have been caused by a number of things. If you are using any kind of Windows theme enhancements programs, turn them off or uninstall them completely to be safe. If you have any other Windows OS in dual-boot, try using it to see if you have the same problem with your LAN card. If the dialer comes as an program, uninstall it and reinstall.

How do you overclock?

My PC consists of a XFX n630i/ Geforce 7100 motherboard, Intel Core 2 Duo E7200@2.53 GHz, 2 GB Transcend single channel 800 MHz. I want to overclock my CPU but I don't know how to overclock. Please



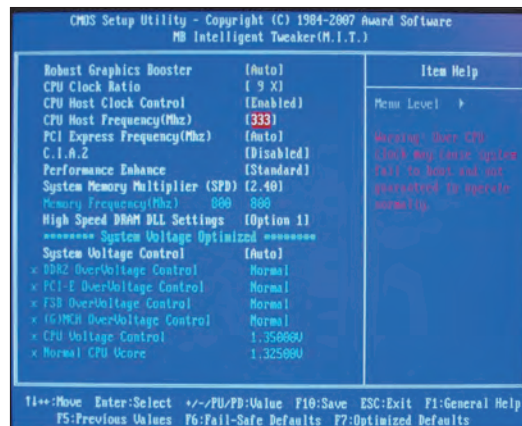
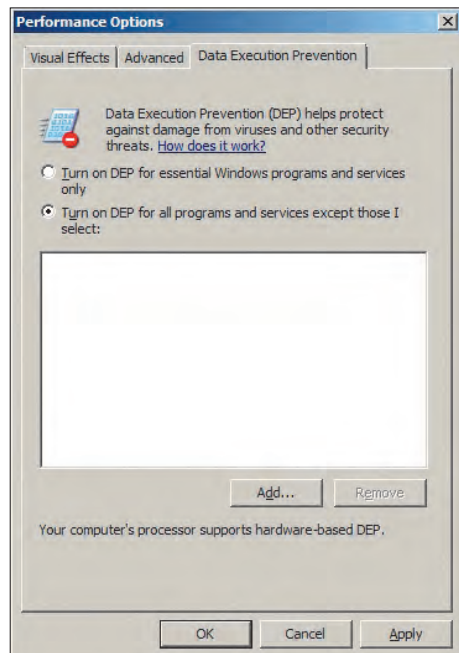
Windows crashing on connecting to the internet

tell me about it. Also, is there a limit I can overclock it to without using any cooling solution.

Shrirang

Firstly, the motherboard you are using needs to support overclocking features in the BIOS. Get into the BIOS by pressing [Del] during bootup. Overclocking is extremely risky and is not recommended. It involves changing the multiplier and FSB of the board in really tiny increments (by 1 MHz at a time) till you get a stable overclock where Windows boots and runs flawlessly. Run CPU intensive games to be sure that the system is stable.

There is no set limit to what speeds a processor can be overclocked to. If you see that the temperature of the processor is already over 45-50C, then there is little you can overclock. A separate cooler is



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